Conquering Leviathan

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Manuscript excerpt

Introduction

Why This Story Had to Be Told

This book was born out of a single, unsettling truth:

It is possible to be obedient to God and still be far from Him.

Scripture does not shy away from this reality. From the opening chapters of Genesis to the final words of Jesus, the greatest danger facing humanity has never been blatant rebellion, but righteousness practiced apart from relationship. The most devastating falls in Scripture are not moral collapses, but relational separations—moments when faith quietly gives way to self-sufficiency.

Adam and Eve did not fall because they sought evil. They fell because they were tricked into independence. They were not trying to overthrow God; they were deceived into believing they could become like Him—knowing how to live rightly—without remaining dependent on Him. The fracture of Eden was not primarily moral. It was relational.

That same deception echoes throughout Scripture.

Job was upright, blameless, and faithful—yet God still confronted him. Not for sin, but for presumption. Job's repentance was not over wrongdoing, but over standing in a place that belonged to God alone. Paul was zealous beyond his peers, perfectly aligned with the law, yet his righteousness had to be dismantled before grace could live within him. The rich young ruler had kept every commandment, but when Jesus invited him into true faith—faith that required surrender rather than achievement—he walked away sorrowful, unable to let go of control.

Even those who performed miracles in Jesus' name were rejected, not because of what they did, but because of what they lacked: relationship.

"I never knew you."

These stories reveal a sobering truth:

Anything done apart from faith—even obedience—can become sin.

Scripture declares, "Whatsoever is not of faith is sin." This is not merely a moral statement; it is a relational one. Actions not rooted in faith, dependence, and abiding can become self-sustaining systems of righteousness—impressive, disciplined, and ultimately empty.

This book explores that truth through story rather than argument.

Conquering Leviathan is not a critique of obedience, discipline, or righteousness. These are gifts. But when they are severed from faith, they quietly become substitutes for God Himself. The Leviathan named in this story is not wickedness in its obvious forms. It is pride disguised

as faithfulness, control mistaken for obedience, fear dressed as righteousness.

The story that follows invites the reader to confront a question Scripture asks again and again:

Will faith be something you perform, or something you receive?

This is not a book about falling away. It is a book about letting go. And in that letting go, discovering life and life more abundantly.

Foreword Reflection

To the Faithful Who Are Tired

There are people who will recognize themselves in this story immediately.

They are not rebels. They are not careless. They are not faithless. They are faithful—and exhausted.

They have prayed when prayer felt empty. They have obeyed when obedience felt costly. They have stood firm when clarity disappeared. They have done everything right, and still sensed that something essential was missing.

If that is you, this story is not written to accuse you.

It is written to invite you to consider.

Many of us were taught how to obey long before we were taught how to abide. We learned discipline before dependence. We learned how to stand before we learned how to lean. And somewhere along the way, faith—meant to be lived in relationship—became something we carried alone.

Fear-based faith teaches us to control, to guard, and to manage righteousness carefully, as though loss were the greatest threat. In the end, obedience severed from faith does not protect righteousness—it replaces God with self-rule.

When obedience is rooted in faith, it becomes life-giving.

When obedience replaces faith, it becomes sin.

Grace-based faith teaches us something far more difficult: to trust that God supplies what we cannot produce—faith itself, guidance, confidence, knowledge, and the fruit that grows only by abiding.

The battle this book calls Leviathan is not fought once. It is fought daily, quietly, in the heart of every sincere believer. It is the battle between fear and grace, law and life, survival and trust.